U15A Rugby Report 2007

Jason Germishuys on attack

Captain: Jason Germishuys **Vice Captain:** Khwezi Mona

The season for me can be summed up in one word and that is 'character'. There were 16 games played in the season with the side wining 9, drawing 1 and losing 6. Little did I know that this season would bring me some of my most treasured memories as a coach? There were many highlights, namely the best try of the season against Dale at home and the great comeback games against Dale and Queens. This all proved how dedicated and determined these boys were. They need to be commended for working really hard through out the season and for never giving up.

The season began with a pre-season tournament in Queenstown, where we beat Westering 76-0, Hangklip 50-5 and drew to Dale 17-17, after being down 0-17 at halftime. The draw against Dale proved that we could compete with the best. Dale was an unbeaten side during their U14 season. The side's comeback in this game will never be forgotten.

The team was able to continue with the momentum gained from tour and beat Grens convincingly 67-0. As a fellow colleague would say "when you think you hot, you not!" the team lost to Paarl Boys 0-27 and then to Grey Kollege 0-31. The boys never lacked commitment and tried their best in both games. We simply had to just work harder. Our next game was against Queens at home. The side played good rugby, dominating in most areas, but lost 13-21. This game was followed by an away game against Graeme which we unfortunately lost 10-15. We then beat Cambridge 29-5 and lost to Dale in Kingwilliam's town, 7-12. All these loses proved how far we were from being competitive against the best sides. The side showed a lot of spirit, dug deep and turned the season around with a great winning streak beating Port Rex 7-0, St Andrews 24-14, Hudson 7-5, Queens 21-19, Dale 17-14, but losing to Grey PE 0-12 in their final game of the season.

The halfback combination of Kevin Luiters (scrum half) and Jason Germishuys (fly half) was unfortunately disrupted by an injury to Kevin. James Allderman, one of the most complete players in the side was more than just an adequate replacement.
Jason at flyhalf and captain, did not only display great leadership qualities, but also developed into a fine prospect for the future.

When the team was settled the final centre combination was Luke Longbottom at inside and Corbin Kretzmann at outside. They are both fine players. I doubt we will ever forget Luke's line break against St Andrews. Corbin was one of the most determined players in the team and could develop into a great player.

Our back three combinations were Jordan Davis (fullback), Ofentse Boloko (left wing) and Lonwabo Semane (right wing). All three players have a lot of potential and could impress in the years to come.

The front row was Chase Morison (loose head prop), Justin Arthur (hooker) and Francios De Klerk (Tight head). Chase did not only establish himself as the best scrumer in the age group, but also proved that he possesses great handling skills often not associated with a prop. Justin's mobility and toughness gave the side an extra edge on their opponents. Francios, not only became a competent scrumager, his mobility was also missed by the side when he was replaced by Liam Dawson after injury. Liam improved with each game and ended the season as a competent prop.

It did not take long for Callan Venter and Andries Janse Van Rensburg, to cement their places in the team at lock. Callan has a bright future in the game and became the team's best line out forward. His big driving runs became a hallmark of our game. Andries always gave 100% and his two tries scored in the Queens game helped the side to victory.

The loose forward combination of Khwezi Mona (Eighthman), Dean Hammond (Open side flank) and Kyle Randall (Blind side flank) worked well together. Khwezi, one of the strongest players in the team, led the pack well and developed into a good No.8. Kyle proved in the season that he had skills and attributes in his game which were uncoachable. Dean established himself as one of the most exciting players in the pack. His high work rate and great skills prove that he has the ability to develop into a fine loose forward.

I would like to thank; Mario Chiodi (loose forward), Vaughan Guest (scrum half), Mathew Christensen (Centre), and Aston Wylie (wing) for their significant contributions to the success of the season.

The ultimate highlight for me as a coach this season was the win against Queens in Queenstown. It is arguably the greatest comeback I have ever witnessed by a team. We were down 7-19 early in the second half, but came back to win the game 21-19. This memory will never be forgotten and I am sure that it will remain as one of my fondest coaching memories.

The team was exposed to lateral thinking and developed well as a unit. By the end of the season the team was more than cable of play two distinctive patterns. There isn't

anything this age group can’t achieve with hard work and team work. I would like to thank the side for a thoroughly enjoyable season. The team can move to the open division next season with plenty of confidence. They not only turned a season around, but also beat Dale and Queens for the first time since U10. I look forward to watching their development and progress in the years to come. Apache!